an independent Kashmir.[37] This set of fateful meetings and attendant publicity added to the collective compulsions that prompted Nehru to agree to Abdullah's dismissal and arrest.

The reportage of the Abdullah-Stevenson summit was replete with ironies. First, to Stevenson, Abdullah had sounded entirely partial to India.[38] Then, the Indian Ambassador to the US, G. L. Mehta said that no responsible person in the Government of India believed that Stevenson had encouraged Abdullah.[39] Finally, the Indian IB had become convinced by March 1953 that Abdullah's National Conference was in cooperation with the communists.[40] After Abdullah's dismissal, it kept a close eye on the spread of communism in Kashmir. It conducted enquiries in the education, and information and broadcasting departments of the state government and was convinced that the trends were no longer as bad as they were under Abdullah.[41]

In hindsight, it is now clear that Moscow had known that Abdullah's position was under threat for quite some time. Baba Pyare Lal Bedi had met the *TASS* Correspondent in India, N. Pastukhov, whose report had reached Soviet Foreign Minister in April 1953. Bedi had also discussed the challenges of implementing agrarian reforms in Kashmir and warned about the religious chauvinism of the Jan Sangh, Hindu Mahasabha and Praja Parishad in Jammu; all parties that he said were 'inspired by US imperialism'. Nehru, Bedi argued, may or may have allied with the Soviet Union but there was no way that he would openly declare an alliance with the Anglo-US bloc. This is why the American influence in India was restricted to these conservative parties. Finally, Bedi had made it clear that communists in Kashmir should no longer contact Abdullah. Instead, they should use Abdullah to expose the Anglo-US game in Kashmir. Right-wing elements began to gain strength and the communists in Kashmir were in a bad shape in every way. They were numerically small, politically untrained and, under G. M. Sadiq, tactically error-prone.[42] This report helps to understand why Moscow did not bat an eyelid on Abdullah's removal.